

## VAIO Z

Sony to upgrade its VAIO Z with Core i7 and four solid state devices

## HP's Envy

HP announces shipment of Envy15 series laptop which have inbuilt Superspeed USB 3.0 ports



light keeps glowing when the drive is connected to the system. It has a flat wraparound USB cable which is quite useful in the sense that the user does not have to always remember to carry the connecting USB cable. A USB extension wire is also bundled in to provide additional flexibility to using the hard drive.

The 320 GB A-DATA Nobility NH42, is the slimmest drive we tested (12 mm). It comes with a leather pouch, and since its mini USB port is on its top edge, it can be used while placed within the pouch as well.

Seagate's FreeAgent Go series of 500 GB portable hard drives comes in as many as six colours. We tested the black coloured portable hard drive having a brushed metal finish. It is perforated on one end and a series of white lights underneath illuminate and pulsate underneath while the drive is working.

### Performance

Performance was divided into two parts namely synthetic testing and real life testing. In synthetic testing we tested the hard drives on HD Tach and SiSoft Sandra 2010 to check the average read/write speeds and access time.

The HD Tach reading for most of the drives were close, with read speeds between 31 MBps and 35 MBps whereas writing speeds averaged 26 MBps to 28 MBps. However, having said that

### DESKTOP HARD DRIVES

| BRAND                                 | WD                 | WD                 | Buffalo           | Seagate           |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Model Name</b>                     | My Book Studio     | My Book Elite      | Drive Station     | FreeAgent Desk    |
| <b>Model Number</b>                   | WDBAAJ0010HSL-NESN | WDBAAH0010HCH-NESN | HD HX 1.0TU3-AP   | ST310005FDA2E1-RK |
| <b>Price (Rs.)</b>                    | Rs.9,999           | Rs.9,249           | Rs.18,000         | Rs. 5,750         |
| <b>Features</b>                       |                    |                    |                   |                   |
| HDD capacity (GB)                     | 930.86             | 930.86             | 931.51            | 931.51            |
| Interface                             | USB 2.0 / FireWire | USB 2.0            | USB 3.0 / USB 2.0 | USB 2.0           |
| Rotational Speed (RPM)                | 7200               | 7200               | 7200              | 7200              |
| Buffer Size (MB)                      | 32                 | 32                 | 32                | 32                |
| <b>Performance</b>                    | <b>32.02</b>       | <b>35.46</b>       | <b>87.57</b>      | <b>30.07</b>      |
| <b>Synthetic Tests</b>                |                    |                    |                   |                   |
| <b>HD Tach 3.0.1.0 (8 MB file)</b>    |                    |                    |                   |                   |
| Average Read (MBps)                   | 29.2 / 33.1        | 32.9               | 115.5 / 35        | 30.8              |
| Average Write (MBps)                  | 24.5 / 25.1        | 25.5               | 77.1 / 28.1       | 25.3              |
| CPU Utilisation (%)                   | 5 / 1              | 4                  | 1 / 7             | 5                 |
| Random Access Time (ms)               | 15.4 / 15          | 14.7               | 13.7 / 13.8       | 12.8              |
| Read Burst Speed (MBps)               | 36.3 / 41.6        | 35.2               | 126.3 / 35.2      | 32                |
| <b>HD Tach 3.0.1.0 (32 MB file)</b>   |                    |                    |                   |                   |
| Average Read (MBps)                   | 34.5 / 40.3        | 34.3               | 115.5 / 34.9      | 30.6              |
| Average Write (MBps)                  | 23.8 / 29.3        | 28.2               | 90.1 / 29.6       | 27.8              |
| CPU Utilisation (%)                   | 5 / 1              | 5                  | 4 / 6             | 6                 |
| Random Access Time (ms)               | 15.5 / 15          | 14.9               | 13.6 / 13.8       | 12.8              |
| Read Burst Speed (MBps)               | 35.2 / 41.7        | 40.4               | 126.2 / 35.2      | 32.8              |
| <b>SiSoft Sandra 2010</b>             |                    |                    |                   |                   |
| Drive Index, Read (MBps)              | 32 / 40.15         | 36.2               | 111.43 / 33       | 29.4              |
| Access Time, read (ms)                | 9.35 / 10.22       | 9.24               | 13.12 / 13.5      | 12.63             |
| Drive Index, Write (MBps)             | 27 / 30.36         | 29.7               | 95.86 / 29        | 28                |
| Access time, write (ms)               | 2.6 / 6.37         | 0.24               | 0.02 / 0.01       | 4.36              |
| <b>Real World Tests (MBps)</b>        |                    |                    |                   |                   |
| File Write 8 GB Single File           | 30.11 / 33.85      | 32.51              | 91.02 / 31.75     | 29.90             |
| File Write Test Assorted 8 GB File    | 25.6 / 30.57       | 29.90              | 77.28 / 29.68     | 27.68             |
| Read Test Single 8 GB File            | 32.25 / 40.55      | 35.93              | 99.90 / 32.25     | 27.68             |
| Read Test Assorted 8 GB File          | 30.79 / 39.01      | 34.13              | 93.09 / 30.8      | 26.95             |
| Photoshop CS2 (1 GB File, in seconds) | 75 / 67            | 68                 | 37 / 71.8         | 88                |

the FireWire interface gave Iomega the maximum readings in all other benchmarks.

The real mettle of the portable hard drives is tested in a real world data transfer scenario. We found that Transcend StoreJet 25M and Iomega Prestige gave the lowest time for a 4GB sequential write operation at 130 seconds. The 4 GB assorted file was also written at fast speeds by the same two drives, both clocking

139 seconds as compared to 186 seconds taken by the Buffalo Mini Station.

The Adobe Photoshop CS2 image opened the quickest in the Transcend StoreJet 25M at 72 seconds leaving behind even the FireWire interface of the Iomega drive at 150 seconds.

Iomega eGo's FireWire port doesn't add value to the performance as was expected in the real world data transfer cases.

### Desktop hard drives

We got four hard disk drives in this category, each having a capacity of 1 TeraByte. This category generally comprises bulky hard drives in which

WD My Book Studio



A-DATA Nobility NH92